AMERICAN POSTAL WORKERS UNION, AFL-CIO

APWU

BUILDING UNION POWER

APWU 26th Biennial National Convention

August 2022

NATIONAL HARBOR, MD

APWU

Mark Dimondstein, President

Anna Smith, Organization Director

"Every moment is an organizing opportunity, every person a potential activist, every minute a chance to change the world."
Dolores Huerta

The National Organization Department is constantly striving to update tools to aide you in your efforts. Organizing is a daily responsibility that is shared by everyone. Let it start with you and others will follow.

If your Local does not currently have an organizing committee, let's start there. Create a committee, appoint a lead, and create a plan. Individually, organizing can be overwhelming, but by dividing up responsibilities and working collectively, every local and state organization will be successful in their efforts.

This journal was designed to make you aware of and provide you with the resources available to assist your local or state with organizing.

Please feel free to reach out to me if I can be of any assistance. I am always open to suggestions and would love to hear from you regarding the successes and failures you experience in organizing.

Organizing in Solidarity,

Anna Smith

Anna Smith, Organization Director
Office: (202) 842-4227
E-mail: asmith@apwu.org
1300 L Street NW, Washington, DC 20005

Your Rights Under the Law

Employees shall have *"the right to self-organization, to form, to join, or assist labor organizations, to bargain collectively through representatives of their own choosing…"*
www.nlrb.gov/rights-we-protect/whats-law/employers/interfering-employee-rights-section-7-8a1

Under the National Labor Relations Act, Sec. 7

The United States Government guarantees your absolute right to:

1. Help form or join a union.
2. Bargain over wages, benefits and working conditions with your employer.
3. Wear union buttons, t-shirts, stickers or other items on the job.
4. Attend meetings to discuss joining a union.
5. Talk about the union during work time, as long as it doesn't interfere with work.
6. Distribute union literature, both on lunch or on breaks, on or off company property.

Our Collective Bargaining Rights

COLLECTIVE BARGAINING AGREEMENT

Between
American Postal Workers Union, AFL-CIO
And
U.S. Postal Service

Article 17
Section 6. Union Participation in New Employee Orientation
During the course of any employment orientation program for new career or non-career employees, or in the event a current postal employee is reassigned to an APWU bargaining unit, a representative of the Union representing the craft or occupational group to which the new or current employees are assigned shall be provided ample opportunity to address such new employees, provided that this provision does not preclude the Employer from addressing employees concerning the same subject. In addition, at the time any non-career employees become eligible for health insurance, the APWU will be provided ample opportunity to address such employees on this subject.

Health benefit enrollment information and forms will not be provided during orientation until such time as a representative of the Union has had an opportunity to address such new employees. (The preceding Section, Article 17.6, shall apply to PSEs.)

Preparing to Organize

Being a leader isn't about power – it's about motivating others to be active, giving direction, and helping them succeed. Experience teaches us that people generally want to be needed – and for the most part enjoy helping others. Being union can serve both purposes, but getting members actively involved is essential. Leaders must point members toward solidarity and empower them to help make our union great.

WHAT MIGHT YOUR ORGANIZING COMMITTEE LOOK LIKE?
Organizing isn't exclusive. Committees should be representative of all crafts. Ask your members who are working right next to the non-members each day for help.

SELECT THOSE WHO ARE VIEWED AS LEADERS
These don't necessarily have to be current stewards or officers. Reach out to those who are viewed as leaders on the workroom floor.

BUILD ON YOUR COMMITTEE
You can always add to the committee, as the committee grows, union organizing will be more apparent. The larger the committee, the more you can divide the tasks.



REACH OUT TO DIFFERENT CULTURAL GROUPS
Don't give people the opportunity to feel as if they are being singled out or not included. Consider if you need materials translated to assist in the effort.

EDUCATE
Organizing is not easy. Provide short training segments to members on how to organize. Take advantage of membership meetings, and small group settings taking a few minutes to discuss a small topic on organizing. Training should be never-ending.

MAKE THE ORGANIZING COMMITTEE KNOWN
Designate a day a week/bi-weekly that organizers wear something that identifies them to their co-workers. We want non-members knowing who to go to if they want to join or ask questions about joining.



Form your team ~ It's everyone's responsibility to organize. However, the team collectively can develop the details of the drive – who, where, when, cost, etc.

Select a lead organizer ~ This is someone who is willing to oversee and run the drive, make calls, and make connections reaching out to others. Identify potential organizers.

Conduct training for team members ~ Discuss why we organize and how to answer some of the tough questions. Find out what concerns our members in asking non-members to join. Prepare talking sheets and guides for organizers.

DETERMINE DIVISION OF RESPONSIBILITIES OF EACH TEAM MEMBER

- Ordering materials / Incentives
- Postings
- Announcements/Advertising – Local publication
- Assemble new member packets
- Membership status reports/Non-member lists & charting
- Team recruitment
- Follow-up plan
- Phone calls to non-members
- Facilitate a Non-Member Forum

DETERMINE YOUR GOALS

- Increase Percentage
- X amount per week/month
- Have x number of one-on-one conversations per week/month

DETERMINE WHO YOU ARE GOING TO TARGET

- Craft
- Tour
- Station/AO/Plant
- Career/PSE
- Previous members
- Long term non-members

DETERMINE THE BUDGET

- Travel
- Loss time
- Incentives
- Local announcements

DETERMINE THE LENGTH OF YOUR ORGANIZING BLITZ

- Months
- Ongoing
- Set time frame

Organizing Plan of Action & Budget Basics

Begin Month / Year: _____

Target Location(s): _____

Target Crafts and/or Tours: _____

Goal: _____

Means/How do you plan to reach goal: _____

Total times non-member will be contacted/reached out to: _____

PREPARE A SCHEDULE/CREATE A CALENDAR

Begin / End Date: _____

Order Supplies By: _____

Mailing Dates (if appropriate): _____

Prepare Materials By: _____

Facility Posting Date: _____

_____

MAKE A BUDGET - Things *to consider*

Recruiting: $ _____

Training: $ _____

Strategy Planning Meetings: $ _____

Loss Time: $ _____

Travel: $ _____

Fliers / Posters / Materials: $ _____

(if any) Refreshments: $ _____

(if any) Incentives: $ _____

Other: $ _____

Other: $ _____

Other: $ _____

Career Local Dues: $ _____

PSE Local Dues: $ _____

Yearly return rate local for each new member: $ _____

PSE Current Dues:

Career Current Dues:

Materials, Resources & Forms



Most of the following materials may also be found on the APWU website at:

http://www.apwu.org/organizers-tool-kit

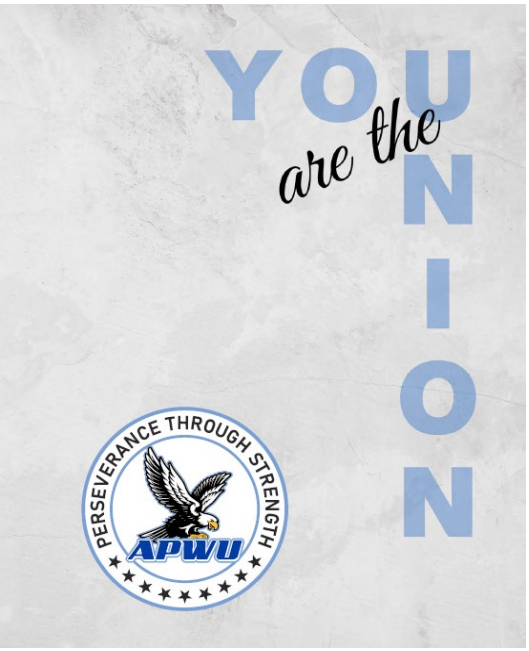
APWU.org / Departments / Department and Divisions / Organization / Resources / Organizers' Tool Kit

Pocket Folder with Welcome Book & 1187

The *Welcome to the APWU* book is geared to help guide you through the new employee orientation. Topics include the mission, structure, legislative efforts and history of the APWU. It also provides insight into the union's safety standards and general benefits in the CBA. Information for all crafts and positions represented by the APWU is listed. The center of the book contains Q&As that you may find helpful.

The pocket folder comes with a Welcome Book as well as an 1187.

Use this folder to your advantage by including information pertaining to your local, some ideas might include:



- ✓ Enclose a letter from the local president, officer or steward.
- ✓ Attach a label to the pocket of the folder that advises members of local information such as the GMM date time and location, picnic date, contact info, etc.
- ✓ Add any local benefit information to the folder.
- ✓ Utilize business card slots for either a local officer's card or perhaps a Weingarten card.



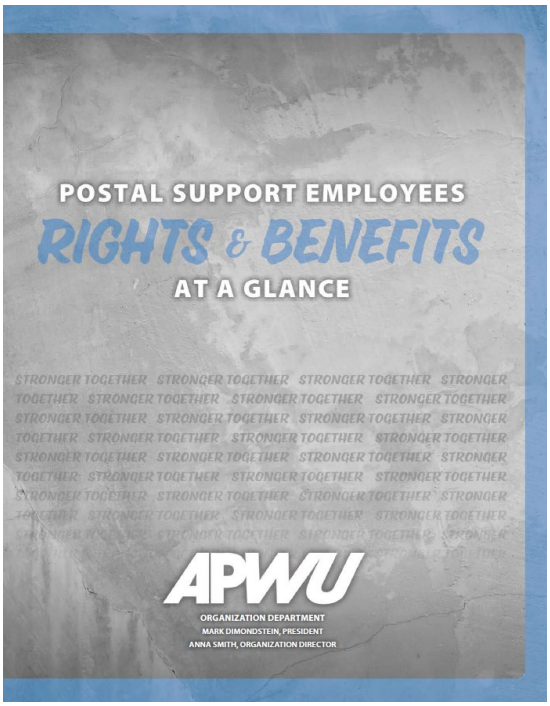
HAVE A PRESENCE ON THE WORKROOM FLOOR!

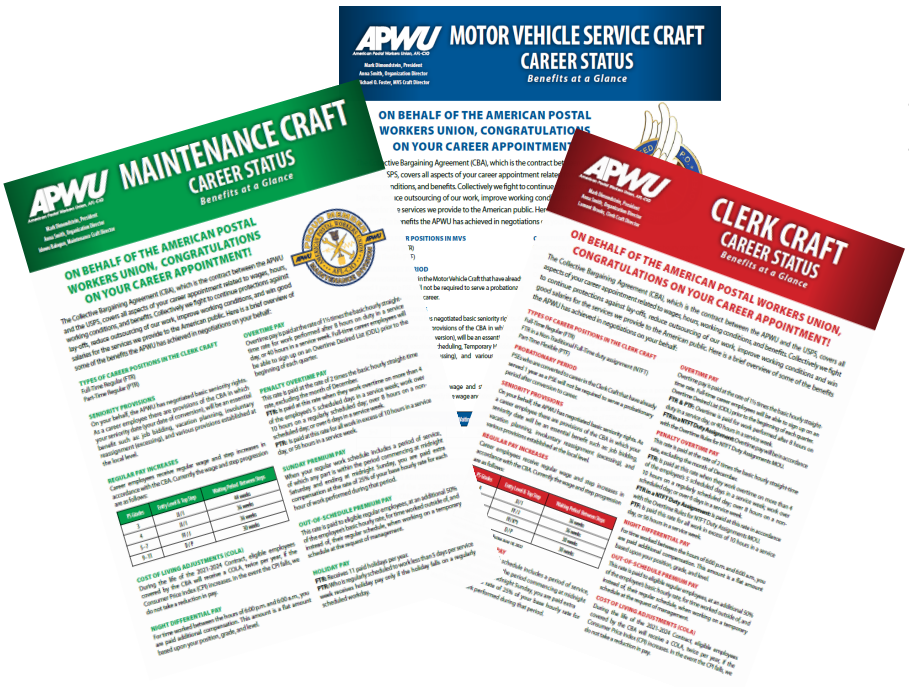
Provide the new member with a lanyard and badge holder at the time they join. These may be ordered thru the Organization Department at no charge.

They are also available on the APWU Store website for those locals wanting to purchase them for all their members.

Postal Support Employee and Career Employees Benefit at a Glance Brochures

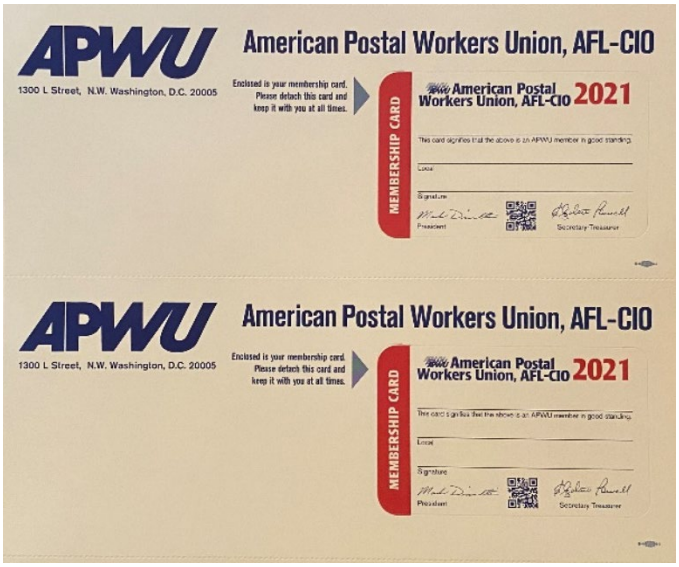
When you are speaking with PSEs, the *PSE Brochure* will guide you through your conversation. As the organizer, try to cover each bullet point in the brochure, but expand on the subject(s) that fit your local. Be sure to provide the information listed on the back page to the new members before parting. This brochure may also be used as a local mailing.





Be sure to have on hand the craft specific Career Status Fliers. These fliers give a brief overview of some of the rights and benefits that we have achived for career craft employees.

- ✓ FTR (Including NTFT)
- ✓ PTR
- ✓ PTF
- ✓ PSE Converted to Career



Blank Membership cards are available for Locals and States to order thru the Organization Department. Have these available to provide new members at the time of join. This gives them instant recognition as an APWU Member

An APWU Health Plan Guide is available to assist during the PSE Health Plan Orientation.

AMERICAN POSTAL WORKERS UNION, AFL-CIO

MARK DIMONDSTEIN, PRESIDENT

STRONGER TOGETHER APWU American Postal Workers Union, AFL-CIO

APWU HEALTH PLAN

Anna Smith, Organization Director
Office Phone: (202) 842-4227

Sarah Rodriguez, Health Plan Director
Office Phone: (410) 424-1503

POSTAL SUPPORT EMPLOYEES
2022 APWU HEALTH BENEFITS ORIENTATION

Orientation Checklist

Items to have on hand when speaking with non-members:



- ☐ Pocket Folder containing Welcome Book and 1187
- ☐ PSE Brochure
- ☐ Career Employee flier *(Craft specific)*
- ☐ APWU Member lanyards and badge holders for new member
- ☐ Local/State contact and website information (Flier and/or Labels*)
  ** See order form for assistance with labels*

Some Benefit programs for Members:

- ☐ Voluntary Benefits Plan Information *To Order Materials call: 800-422-4492*
- ☐ Accident Benefit Association Information *To Order Materials call: 800-526-2890*
- ☐ Union Plus benefits flier & materials *To Order Materials call: 202-293-5330 or visit www.unionplus.org*
- ☐ Aflac Information *To Order Materials call: 855-378-4712*

Other helpful organizing information:

- ☐ Helpful answers to objections about joining the APWU
- ☐ Postal Support Employee and APWU Health Benefits
  http://www.apwu.org/organizers-tool-kit
- ☐ Collective Bargaining Agreement & JCIM Re*: New employee orientation*
- ☐ National MOUs that pertain to PSEs (Include LMOUs)

Missed opportunities to strengthen the APWU are happening every day. Each orientation for new hires, new career employees and PSE enrollment into Federal Employee Health Benefits (FEHB), is a chance for organizers and local union leaders to reach out to possible new members. Each of you can make a big impact by simply taking advantage of the language in the Collective Bargaining Agreement (CBA). We must jump on these crucial minutes to provide education, outreach and empowerment.

Organizing Materials Order Form

RETURN TO: Anna Smith, Organization Director / 1300 L Street NW, Washington, DC 20005 / organization@apwu.org

Please note that some materials are shipped from multiple locations so they not arrive in same shipment

Please indicate quantity:

_____ 1187 in Pocket Folder with APWU Welcome Book

_____ PSE Brochure

Career Benefits at A Glance Flyers *(These are Craft Specific)*

_____ Clerk _____ Maintenance _____ Motor Vehicle

_____ Lanyards (Max 50) ***** *For New Members*

_____ Badge holders (Max 50) ***** *For New Members*

_____ Retractable badge holders (Max 10) ***** *For New Members*

_____ Blank APWU Membership Cards

_____ Additional 1187s only

_____ Guide to Veterans Rights & Benefits (Max 10)

Notes:

** These items are available to provide to new members at the time of joining. For other purposes/events please visit www.apwustore.org*

LABELS FOR WELCOME FOLDER: Available for Locals who need assistance in personalizing the pocket folders with Local/State APWU contact information. Please print below how you would like labels printed:

Line 1: _____

Line 2: _____

Line 3: _____

Line 4: _____

SHIP ORDERS TO: ***(please print clearly)***

Requesters Name: _____

Local/State Name: _____

Email: Address: _____

Mailing Address: _____

City: _____ State: _____ Zip: _____

Your Membership Matters ~ It Takes All of Us!

American Postal Workers Union, AFL-CIO

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE AUTHORIZATION FOR DEDUCTION OF DUES

JOIN THE APWU

I hereby assign to the American Postal Workers Union, AFL-CIO, from any salary or wages earned or to be earned by me as a member (in my present or future employment) such regular and periodic membership dues as the APWU may certify as due and owing from me, as may be established from time to time by the APWU. I authorize and direct the USPS to deduct such amounts from my pay and to remit same to the APWU at such times and in such manner as may be agreed upon between myself and the APWU at any time while this authorization is in effect, which includes a yearly subscription for The American Postal Worker magazine as part of the membership dues.

This assignment, authorization and direction shall be irrevocable for a period of one (1) year from the date of delivery to the APWU, and I agree and direct that this assignment, authorization and direction shall be automatically renewed and shall be irrevocable for successive periods of one (1) year unless written notice by certified mail using PS Form 1186 is given by me to the APWU not more than twenty (20) days and not less than ten (10) days prior to the expiration of each period of one year, or within ten (10) days after the date I start work if I am rehired for any new term of Postal Support employment. In addition to the above, if I am a Postal Support Employee, this assignment shall remain in effect if I should be rehired within 180 days after the conclusion of my present term of Postal Support employment.

This agreement is freely made pursuant to the provisions of the Postal Reorganization Act and is not contingent upon the existence of any agreement between the Union and the Postal Service.

LAST NAME *(Please Print)*	**FIRST NAME** *(Please Print)*	**MI**	**SOCIAL SECURITY NO.** *or* **EIN (***Entire SS# Is Req.)*

MAILING ADDRESS	**CITY**	**STATE**	**ZIP**

HOME PHONE NO.	**MOBILE PHONE NO.**	**EMAIL ADDRESS**
( )	( )	

WORK LOCATION *(Post Office)* **& STATE**	**WORK FINANCE NUMBER**	**CRAFT**	**POSITION TYPE** *(Check One)*
	_ _ - _ _ _ _		CAREER PSE

SIGNATURE OF EMPLOYEE	**DATE**	**ARE YOU CURRENTLY PAYING DUES TO ANOTHER UNION?** *If so, select which union dues should be cancelled:* NALC NPMHU NRLCA

Would you like to receive mobile text alerts from APWU? YES NO

If you choose to receive mobile alerts, you are authorizing the mobile communications. Note: Msg & data rates may apply. Text STOP to 91990 to stop receiving messages. Text HELP to 91990 for more information.

Preferred Contact Number HOME MOBILE

By selecting my preferred contact number, I am authorizing the APWU to call me or send me recorded messages using automated technology to the telephone number entered above.

FIGHTING TODAY *for a* BETTER TOMORROW

HOW CAN YOU HELP IN THE FIGHT?



___ Outreach – Representing the APWU at events and meetings, etc.
___ Welcoming New Members – Orientations, organizing, etc.
___ Work Place Safety – Daily huddles, weekly talks, safety captain, etc.
___ Community Involvement – Talking with neighbors, family and friends about issues
___ Transportation – Getting people to and from events, meetings, etc.

In addition to having a voice and a vote in your union, and all of the collective bargaining rights you rely on you will have the opportunity to participate in the following programs: APWU MasterCard, Voluntary Benefits Plan, Union Plus, Accident Benefit Association, and Aflac.

FOR USE BY UNION OFFICIAL

I hereby certify that the regular dues of this organization for the above-named member are currently established at $ _____ biweekly.

SIGNATURE AND TITLE OF AUTHORIZED UNION OFFICIAL	**DATE**

LOCAL UNION NAME *(or State if MAL office)*	**LOCAL UNION FINANCE NUMBER**

ORGANIZER'S NAME	**NOTES**

Please return original to the APWU Organization Department at: 1300 L Street NW, Washington, DC 20005 **Form 1187**

VOLUNTEER SIGN-UP

PRINT NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

PHONE NO: _____

EMAIL: _____

LOCAL NAME: _____

WORK LOCATION: _____

DAYS AVAILABLE: SA SU MO TU WE TH FR

SIGNATURE: _____

CHECK AREAS YOU ARE WILLING TO ASSIST WITH:

___ **Welcoming New Members** ***orientations, organizing*

___ **Work Place Safety** ***daily huddles, weekly talks, Safety Capitan*

___ **Outreach** ***representing the APWU at events and meetings*

___ **Politics** ***phone banks, candidate interviews, educating, lobbying*

___ **Organizing Social Events** ***annual picnic, team building, BBQ's*

___ **Social Justice** ***immigration reform, civil rights*

___ **Community Involvement** ***speaking with others about issues*

___ **Social Media Skills** ***creating websites, computer skills, data entry*

___ **Home Visits** ***visiting nonmembers and/or members in need*

___ **Rallies** ***participating in rally events*

___ **Transportation** ***getting people to and from events or meetings*

___ **Bilingual Translation** ***other languages known* _____

*** Examples*



RETURN FORM TO:

VOLUNTEER SIGN-UP

PRINT NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

PHONE NO: _____

EMAIL: _____

LOCAL NAME: _____

WORK LOCATION: _____

DAYS AVAILABLE: SA SU MO TU WE TH FR

SIGNATURE: _____

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___ **Bilingual Translation** ***other languages known* _____

*** Examples*



RETURN FORM TO:

Non-Members

- ✓ Have one-on-one conversations – Consider asking non-members to stand with you/us instead of asking them to *“join the union”*
- ✓ Keep track of the conversations with non-members go by utilizing the assessment log
- ✓ Reach out to non-members that you/we have be successful in the grievance procedure for
- ✓ Follow-up with non-members who have said they want to *“think about it”*



Steps to having a conversation with a Non-Member

1. INTRODUCTION

When introducing yourself, let them know who you are, and make the connection between the two of you. We may not work in the same section, or post office, but they are still our coworkers.

"Hi there, my name is _____ and I am a member of the American Postal Workers Union. We are talking to our coworkers today about making some changes at work."

Immediately ask a question that helps set the direction of the conversation:

EXAMPLE: "How long have you worked for the Post Office?"

2. LISTENING AND GETTING THE STORY

Get your coworker to talk about their issues at work by asking:

Fact-based, detailed questions / Probing follow-up questions / "Who decides" questions

Find out all of their issues; don't stop them after their first issue. Do not get defensive nor feel you have to solve all of their issues. Do not make promises to take care of their issues.

Asking your coworker "who decides" questions to help them see the source of their frustration.

EXAMPLE: "Whose decision is it to work you overtime?"

"Management" will most likely be their response. When they have stated all their issues, ask a transition question:

EXAMPLE: "What happens when you (and your co-workers) have brought (their specific issue) to management?"

3. EDUCATE OUR COWORKERS & GIVE THEM A VISION

Ask questions to show how when we work together we can and do make a difference; how the power changes when we are standing together:

EXAMPLE: "Do you know how (their specific problem) might be different if everyone in your section/office were members of the APWU?"

EXAMPLE: "What if we all went to management together to discuss (the issue)?

4. ASSESS, AGITATE & MOVE INTO ACTION

How do we know if they are ready to join with us? We ask them! Ask the assessment question:

EXAMPLE: "Are you ready to stand with you co-workers today?"

Challenge them to take action. Help them make the connection and see how taking action with their coworkers gets them closer to fixing their problems. Once they join, ask your co-workers for their commitment to get involved.

Ignore their excuses! If your coworker is still undecided about joining with you, circle back to their issues (#2).

Non-member Contact & Assessment Log

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

(IF ADDRESS IS BAD WRITE THE FULL GOOD ADDRESS ON BACK OF THIS CONTACT SHEET)

HOME PHONE: _____ **CELL:** _____ **EMAIL:** _____

GENDER: _____ **ETHNICITY:** _____ **CRAFT:** _____ **SHIFT:** _____ **DAYS OFF:** _____

CAREER or NON-CAREER: _____ **POST OFFICE:** _____ **SENIORITY:** _____

SIGNED MEMBERSHIP FORM? ☐ **YES** ☐ **NO**

WORKPLACE ISSUES:

_____

_____

_____

CONCERNS ABOUT THE UNION:

_____

_____

ANSWER WHEN THEY ARE ASKED TO JOIN: ***(See Assessment bottom right)***

_____

_____

_____

SUGGESTED FOLLOW UP:

_____

_____

_____

ORGANIZER(S): _____ **DATE:** _____

COMMENTS:

ASSESSMENT CODES:

1. Joins & supports the APWU, will be on committees & take action.
2. Supports the APWU, has issues, reluctant to take action, but agrees to join.
3. Undecided at this time, but potentially moveable to join. Is not opposed to getting involved.
4. Does not want to be involved in any way.

Assessment Code: ____
Date: _____
Assessed by: _____

Assessment: _____
Date: _____
Assessed by: _____

Assessment: _____
Date: _____
Assessed by: _____

Assessment: _____
Date: _____
Assessed by: _____

Sample letter to so send to non-member after grievance settlement – *Any Issue*

When settling a grievance in which a non-member benefits from the resolve, follow-up with the non-member.

[DATE]

[NAME]
[STREET]
[CITY], [ST] [ZIP]

Dear **[NAME],**

The American Postal Workers Union was pleased to be able to win **[TYPE HERE WHAT WE ACHIEVED]**. Members of the **[LOCAL NAME]** are doing everything they can for you by making sure your rights are respected and by winning grievances on your behalf. We appreciate you having the same value for your Local by joining us.

Enclosed is a sign-up form. Please fill out the form and return it using the enclosed envelope. If you have any questions as you fill out the form, please feel free to call the union office at **[PHONE]**.

The members of your local do an incredible amount of work for postal workers, such as negotiating pay raises and ensuring that your rights are not violated. With the state of the Postal Service today, we need to stand together to make sure the good job you have will last.

Make a difference today by completing the enclosed sign-up form and returning it in the postage-paid envelope. As a member of **[LOCAL NAME]**, your dues will be **[DUES AMOUNT]** per pay period.
Sincerely,

[NAME], [TITLE]
[LOCAL NAME], [APWU]

Sample letter to so send to non-member after grievance settlement – *Removal Case*

[DATE]

[NAME]
[STREET]
[CITY], [ST] [ZIP]

Dear **[NAME],**

The American Postal Workers Union was pleased to be able to win your job at the Postal Service back, **including securing your back pay** ***(include this ONLY if achieved)***. Members of the **[LOCAL NAME]** are doing everything they can for you by making sure your rights are respected and by winning grievances on your behalf. We appreciate you having the same value for your Local by joining us.

Enclosed is a sign-up form. Please fill out the form and return it using the enclosed envelope. If you have any questions as you fill out the form, please feel free to call the union office at **[PHONE]**.

Your union does an incredible amount of work for postal workers, such as negotiating pay raises and ensuring that your rights are not violated. With the state of the Postal Service today, we need to stand together to make sure the good job you have will last.

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Sincerely,

[NAME], [TITLE]
[LOCAL NAME], [APWU]

PRODUCED BY THE
ORGANIZATION DEPARTMENT
Mark Dimondstein, President
Anna Smith, Organization Director